

Tablets from Acer

Acer has unveiled three tablets, the 5 and 7-inch ones running on Android OS whereas the 10-inch one running on Windows 7

\$213,600 for an Apple 1

An Apple 1, that was launched in 1976 for \$666.66 was auctioned off at Christies for a whopping \$2,13,600

AMD Radeon HD 6870 and HD 6850 GPUs hit markets

AMD has launched the Radeon HD 6800 series with the HD 6870 and the HD 6850, which unlike what you'd expect, are the next-gen replacements for the HD 5770 and the HD 5750, or the performance-mainstream market. The upcoming HD 6900 series, which is now rumoured to arrive sometime before the end of the year, will replace both the HD 5800 and 5900 series, or the high-end performance market.

The HD 6850 has a suggested retail price of \$179.99, while the HD 6870 has a suggested price \$239.99. Apart from full support for 6-way Eyefinity, AMD

claims that HD 6800 series has better tessellation execution that helps give up to 30% performance improvement over Nvidia's competing graphic cards, as well as new features such as morphological anti-aliasing and enhanced anisotropic filtering performance.

How NVIDIA's efforts will compare with AMD's remains a very pertinent question, and for now however, until the HD 6900 series rolls out (the dual-GPU [Antilles] HD 6990 is now rumoured to release only in Q1 2011), the GTX 580 definitely holds the crown of the "fastest DX11 GPU on the planet", with much more grace than the GTX 480. 

ASUS shows off upcoming boards

ASUS recently held several technical seminars across the world. Digit was invited to one held in Singapore late October. ASUS showed some of their upcoming boards based on Intel's P67 chipset. One of the boards to be showcased was the Sabertooth P67 was one of the interesting designs with a clean flush surface covering most of the board. There are also plenty of sensors in the board which give the user an accurate idea of hot spots. ASUS calls it the Tactical Vest and its aimed at improving air flow around the board.

Following the rest of the RoG series, was the Maximus IV Extreme board based on the same P67 chipset. The board is aimed at extreme overclockers and there have been some unique features such as overclocking remotely using an iPad or iPhone.

ASUS also showed many other P8P67 boards for different price brackets and in different form factors. One that caught our eye was a mini-ITX board. The seminar highlighted some of the features designed for their upcoming boards, after which there were overclocking demos shown by R&D staff from ASUS. 

Microsoft takes on Google Apps with Office 365 cloud service

Microsoft has announced a new cloud service, called Office 365, which will include various Office desktop software as well Office Web Apps, online at www.office365.com. The service will also include SharePoint, Exchange and Lync. It will officially go online next year, though beta testing opens now.

The hosted software for business is not free, and is available for small businesses, professionals and small companies with fewer than 25 employees, starting from \$6 per user per month. This will include only web-based Office software.

Office 365 for enterprises for midsize and large businesses, will start at \$2 per user per month for basic e-mail, ranging up to \$24 per user per month for the complete deal, including the full Office Professional Plus desktop suite, communications server tools, online versions of the desktop software, voicemail, enterprise social networking, instant messaging, Sharepoint, Exchange, Web portals, extranets, voice conferencing, Web conferencing, 24x7 phone support, and on-premises licenses.

The platform will apparently work across multiple devices, and will introduce great new

collaborative as well as security features. It is expected to include Microsoft Dynamics CRM Online soon. Microsoft is obviously taking on Google Apps, and to be fair, Google offers a free service for consumers and small businesses with Google Docs and Gmail. Google Apps also has a paid business version, for \$50 per user per year. Microsoft previously retailed its Business Productivity Online Suite for \$120 per user per year, so the varying price points for different sizes of businesses.

According to Microsoft Office president Kurt DelBene:

"Moving to the cloud with Office 365 means people don't have to change the way they work, because [the suite] works with the most popular browsers,

smartphones and desktop applications people use today."

"With Office 365, your local bakery can get enterprise-calibre software and services for the first time, while a multinational pharmaceutical company can reduce costs and more easily stay current with the latest innovations. People can focus on their business, while we and our partners take care of the technology." 



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